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Iconic Revisions of the Modern World Picture

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We live in an age of image. This simple statement, often repeated, has complex ramifications; for the extent of the image is much wider than art and television where it obviously appears most often. To even begin to measure it's the significance of the image, we must consider a complicated web of discourses, ranging from art and aesthetics to science and technology, and passing through theories of subjectivity and the possibility of God or the gods. For, as the art historian Hans Belting has said, "the history of religion and the history of the human subject [¹]

> "This picture brethren, ye shall set up in some place, let us say, on a north wall and shall
 5). In this experiment, a man monk walks from west to east and then back from east to west with
 embracing of the world in its totality. Likewise when all stand still in a semi-circle surround

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Jeffrey L. Kosky is the author of *Levinas and the Philosophy of Religion* and the translator of Jean-Luc Marion's *Being Given: Toward a Phenomenology of Givenness* and *On Descartes' Metaphysical Prism: The Constitution and the Limits of Onto-theo-logy in Cartesian Thought*. He has taught at Williams College, DePaul University, and, currently, Bucknell University.

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